

Bigfoot 200 — the sub-100 plan

Race: Friday August 13, 2027, 12:00 PM · Marble Mountain Sno-Park → Randle, WA **Course:** 200.1 mi · 44,082 ft gain · 45,563 ft loss · **107-hour limit** **Goal:** finish under **100:00** — the Western States qualifying standard **Support:** unsupported. Drop bags at every aid station, no crew, no pacers. **Today:** September 6, 2026 · 49 weeks out

The course numbers here come from the 2027 official runner manual. Most of the internet still describes a ~208-mile version of this race with aid stations at Windy Ridge and Johnston Ridge. That course is retired. Ignore any plan built on it.

Read this first

Three things changed the moment the goal became sub-100 rather than "finish."

1. Sub-100 is not a fitness target. It is a stopped-time target. The gap between 107 and 100 hours is 6.5%. You will not find seven hours by running harder — at mile 150 there is no harder. You find it by not being stationary. The budget below allows **6 hours of sleep and 4 hours 12 minutes of aid across 12 stations** — an average stop of 21 minutes, unsupported, doing your own resupply. A single two-hour sit-down at Chain of Lakes, which is exactly what happens to people, costs a third of your margin. The discipline that produces sub-100 is rehearsed in training or it does not exist on race day.

2. Unsupported is the expensive choice, and it costs roughly what you're trying to save. A crew hands you a prepared bottle and a plate and pushes you out. Unsupported you filter, sort a drop bag, refill, eat, and repack, alone, in the dark, at hour 84. Realistically that is **two to four hours** across the race versus a competent crew — most of your sub-100 margin. You also lose pacers, who are permitted from Elk Pass (mile 67.2) onward, through the two sections the race is known for losing people in, both of which you will now hit alone at night.

That is not a reason to abandon sub-100. It is a reason to be honest that **finding a crew is worth more than any training block in this plan.** If sub-100 genuinely matters, solving crew is the highest-leverage thing on this page. If unsupported is fixed, the plan below still works — it just spends its margin on self-sufficiency instead of speed.

3. Bighorn would be your first 100-mile finish, eight weeks before a 200. Your longest to date is Gorge Waterfalls 100K. The current plan goes 100K → nothing → first 100 at Bighorn in June → sub-100 at a 200 in August. That is two debuts stacked eight weeks apart, with the

second one unsupported and four nights long. Bighorn stops being a gate and becomes an experiment, and an experiment is a bad thing to hang an A-race on.

Recommendation: add a 100-mile finish in winter. [BURT 100](#) on Bainbridge Island, WA, Feb 6 2027, sits at the end of Block 2, is close to home, and is PNW winter — which is the condition you'll be training in anyway. Coldwater Hundred (Goodyear AZ, Jan 16) is the warm-and-forgiving alternative if you'd rather your first 100 not also be a weather event. Either one turns Bighorn back into what it's supposed to be: a gate you pass, not a coin flip.

The race plan — 97:00 schedule, 100:00 goal

The goal is sub-100. **The schedule is built to 97:00**, and the three-hour difference is not padding you hope to keep — it is the thing that makes sub-100 likely rather than a coin flip. You do not pace to the number you want to hit. You pace to a number that still gets you there after something goes wrong, because something will.

Aid station	Mile	Seg	Gain	Moving	Stop	Arrive	Depart	Clock	Cutoff	In hand
Blue Lake	12.2	12.2	3,280	4:49	0:09	4:49	4:58	Fri 4:49 PM	5.5	0:42
Coldwater Lake	37.4	25.2	4,002	9:51	0:25	14:49	15:15	Sat 2:49 AM	22.0	7:11
Norway Pass	56.1	18.7	5,105	7:53	0:20	23:08	23:27	Sat 11:07 AM	32.0	8:55
Elk Pass	67.2	11.1	2,037	3:59	0:20	27:26	27:46	Sat 3:26 PM	37.5	10:04
RD 9327	82.2	15.0	2,543	5:18	2:10	33:04	35:14	Sat 9:03 PM	45.5	12:27

Aid station	Mile	Seg	Gain	Moving	Stop	Arrive	Depart	Clock	Cutoff	In hand
Spencer Butte	93.4	11.2	2,817	4:40	0:15	39:54	40:09	Sun 3:54 AM	52.0	12:05
Lewis River	101.0	7.6	1,282	2:36	0:25	42:45	43:11	Sun 6:45 AM	56.0	13:15
Quartz Ridge	118.2	17.2	7,347	10:08	0:25	53:19	53:44	Sun 5:18 PM	65.5	12:11
Chain of Lakes	134.4	16.2	3,846	6:48	2:10	60:33	62:43	Mon 12:32 AM	73.0	12:27
Klickitat	151.7	17.3	3,927	8:07	0:25	70:50	71:15	Mon 10:49 AM	82.5	11:40
Twin Sisters	171.1	19.4	4,919	11:33	2:55	82:48	85:43	Mon 10:47 PM	93.5	10:42
Owens Creek	187.1	16.0	2,592	7:39	0:15	93:22	93:37	Tue 9:21 AM	101.5	8:08
FINISH	200.1	13.0	385	3:23	—	97:00	—	Tue 1:00 PM	107.0	10:00

Budget: 86:48 moving · 4:12 aid · 6:00 sleep. Moving average **2.31 mph** across 44,082 ft.

Two reserves, and they are different things

Reserve 1 — three hours of schedule slack. The gap between the 97:00 plan and the 100:00 goal. This absorbs the ordinary: a bad stomach hour, a wrong turn, a longer stop than you meant, weather. You spend it without deciding to.

Reserve 2 — two and a half hours of sleep at Twin Sisters. Deliberate, and spent on purpose.

Sleep is three naps: **1:45 at RD 9327** (mile 82, Saturday night), **1:45 at Chain of Lakes** (mile 134, Sunday night), **2:30 at Twin Sisters** (mile 171, Monday night). No sleep Friday night — you run the blast zone through the dark.

The weighting toward Twin Sisters is deliberate. It sits at mile 171 with 29 miles left, *after* both of the sections this race is known for, and the last 13 of those miles are road that has to be **run** at 3.8 mph. Most people arrive at mile 171 having spent their sleep early and then walk a finish they could have run. Sleeping there converts directly into time.

It is also your second lever. Cut it to a 45-minute nap and you claw back 1:45. Together the two reserves give you **about five and a half hours** against the 100:00 goal — but they are spent in order, and you should never touch the second one before mile 171.

The decision point is Chain of Lakes, mile 134, target 60:33:

- **On plan or ahead** → run the schedule. Full sleep at Twin Sisters, run the finish.
- **Up to 2 hours down** → still fine. That's Reserve 1 doing its job. Change nothing.
- **3 to 4 hours down** → cut Twin Sisters to 1:15 and keep moving.
- **More than 5 hours down** → sub-100 is gone. Switch to finishing inside 107, which you will have ten hours of margin for, and enjoy the rest of it.

Do not buy sleep before mile 151. Extra sleep at RD 9327 or Chain of Lakes feels like the same hours, but it pushes Klickitat → Twin Sisters later, and that section has to happen in daylight. That's the one thing the schedule is shaped to protect.

What the clock puts where

- **The ropes and the knee-deep crossing arrive at dusk.** They sit about 7.4 miles into the Blue Lake → Coldwater segment, roughly mile 19.6, around hour 7 — Friday evening, light going. Solo, on fixed ropes, into a river. Know the descriptions and have lights out before you need them.
- **The blast zone is a night crossing.** 25.2 miles, no aid, last non-silty water at segment mile 6.2, and you're in it from Friday evening to 2:49 AM Saturday. The cutoff pace here is the most generous on the course (1.53 mph) because the race knows it's slow. Carry for ten hours.
- **Mt Margaret lands in daylight.** Saturday morning, which is what the manual recommends and the best thing about this pacing.
- **Klickitat → Twin Sisters is almost entirely daylight — protect this above everything.** Depart Klickitat 11:15 AM Monday, arrive Twin Sisters 10:47 PM. The notorious 19.4-mile blowdown section — faint trail, downed logs, bushwhacking, the

section every single race report names — gets eleven and a half of its twelve hours in the light, and you are unsupported and alone in it. This is what Reserve 1 is really for.

- **Blue Lake is the tightest cutoff you'll ever be near.** 42 minutes in hand at mile 12.2, off a 3,280 ft climb in afternoon heat. The only point on the course where the plan is close to a cutoff. Don't let a hot first climb become a race-ending one.
- **The last 13 miles are road, 385 ft of gain, and must be run.** 3:23 for 13 miles is 3.8 mph at hour 94. The most trainable segment on the course, the place most people stop being able to run, and the reason Twin Sisters gets the biggest sleep.

The same plan in 50K legs

Six and a half 50Ks, back to back, on four hours' sleep a night. Leg time is wall clock — it includes every aid stop and nap that falls inside that leg.

Leg	Miles	Gain	Leg time	Moving	Stoppe d	Moving mph	Elapse d	Arrive
1	0 – 31.1	6,277	12:21	12:12	0:09	2.55	12:21	Sat 12:20 AM
2	31.1 – 62.1	7,218	13:17	12:32	0:45	2.48	25:37	Sat 1:37 PM
3	62.1 – 93.2	6,240	14:12	11:42	2:30	2.66	39:49	Sun 3:49 AM
4	93.2 – 124.3	10,120	16:28	15:22	1:05	2.02	56:17	Sun 8:17 PM
5	124.3 – 155.3	7,255	17:08	14:33	2:35	2.14	73:25	Mon 1:25 PM
6	155.3 – 186.4	6,476	19:37	16:42	2:55	1.86	93:02	Tue 9:02 AM
7	186.4 – 200.1	497	3:58	3:43	0:15	3.68	97:00	Tue 1:00 PM

Overall 2.06 mph including every stop and all the sleep. Your first 50K is 12:21 and your sixth is 19:37 — a 59% slowdown, which is what the plan expects and budgets for. Leg 6 is the blowdown. Leg 7 is the road, and it's the only leg you run.

What changes in training

The volume spine stays. What it's pointed at changes.

Re-based, because the old baseline was wrong

Your Strava history says you're averaging **8.8 hr/week and 1,700 ft/week** over the last twelve weeks, not the 12 hr and 3,000 ft the original plan assumed. Vertical is the gap: the original Block 1 target of 5,000 ft/week was 2.9× your real starting point, not 1.7×. Ramping that fast is how you arrive at Block 2 injured. The blocks below start where you actually are.

Block	Dates	Hr/wk	Vert/wk	Mi/wk	Peak day	Night hrs (cum)	Ends with
Baseline	—	8.8	1,700	29	3:00	0	measured
1	Sep 7 – Dec 13	10 → 15	2,000 → 4,500	32 → 50	8 hr	4	Frozen Trail 50K
2	Dec 14 – Feb 14	17	6,000	55	10–12 hr	12	first 100-mile r
3	Feb 15 – Apr 18	19	7,500	60	14 hr	24	Gorge Waterfalls 100K
4	Apr 19 – Jun 20	21	9,500	65	18 hr	40	Bighorn 100 — the gate
5	Jun 21 – Aug 15	23 peak	12,000 peak	70	20 hr	60	BIGFOOT 200

Cumulative vertical lands near **303,000 ft** — about 6.9× the race. Lower than the 8.5× the original plan wanted, because it's built from where you are rather than where the document assumed you were. The ratio is honest; the old one wasn't.

Five things sub-100 adds that "finish" didn't

1. Night hours double, and they stop being a checkbox. 30 cumulative night hours was enough to not be frightened of the dark. You will be moving through **four nights, alone, unsupported**, roughly 40 hours of it. The target is now **60 cumulative**, and the shape matters more than the total: at least two efforts that cross a full night and continue into the next day, and one in Block 4 that crosses **two** nights. Start in October, not November.

2. Sleep restriction is a recurring session, not a Block 4 stunt. Two sessions on under four hours' sleep does not prepare you for 6 hours across 4 days. From Block 2 on, one long day per month starts on deliberately short sleep. In Blocks 4 and 5, practice the actual protocol: 2 hours down, alarm, up and moving inside 15 minutes. The skill is the waking up, not the sleeping.

3. Aid station discipline becomes a measured thing. 21 minutes average, unsupported, is a trained behavior. On every long day from Block 1: drop a bag at the car, and time the stop. Target under 10 minutes for a resupply, under 25 with a full change. Practice with cold hands. Practice at night. The failure mode is not one long stop — it's twelve average stops that each ran ten minutes over.

4. Descent volume gets its own prescription. 45,563 ft of loss, more than the gain. The descent HR gap monitor was already the right instrument; now it needs volume behind it. From Block 2: **one descent-focused session per week, on rock, late in the day, on tired legs.** Not loam, not fresh. The plan's original non-negotiable was right and under-resourced.

5. Late-race running speed becomes a training target. The last 13 miles are road at 3.8 mph and there are runnable stretches all through Lewis River, Chain of Lakes, and Owens Creek. Everyone can hike at 2.3 mph on day one. Almost nobody can still *run* on day four, which is exactly where the seven hours live. **Every long day from Block 2 ends with 30–60 minutes at target race pace on runnable ground.** It will feel pointless and stupid at the end of an eight-hour day. That is the point.

Also, because unsupported

- **Carry weight is now a training variable.** The 25.2-mile blast zone crossing with silty water means filtering plus a real carry. Do long days with race pack weight from Block 2, not Block 5.
- **Filtering is a rehearsed skill.** Silty water, at night, tired. Practice with the actual filter.
- **Heat acclimation starts in Block 4, not Block 5.** Noon start, blast zone, no shade, reports of 90°F, and no crew handing you ice. Six sessions was the plan when someone else was carrying your cooling. Make it twelve, starting in May.
- **Navigation is on you.** Two sections of this course have "the trail becomes faint and disappears" in the *official manual*. Practice night navigation off-trail, solo.

Checkpoint races, re-standardized

Race	When	Old standard	Sub-100 standard
Run the Rock 50K	Nov 7	3.2 mph, finish upright	unchanged — it's a checkpoint, not a test
Frozen Trail 50K	Dec	finish	negative split; last hour running
First 100	Feb	—	finish, with a full night solo and under 45 min total aid
Gorge Waterfalls 100K	Apr	2.8 mph, 16–18 hr	14–15 hr , and run the last 10K
Bighorn 100	Jun	finish under 30 hr	under 28 hr , with the second half no worse than 15% slower than the first, and total aid under 90 minutes

That Bighorn standard is the real gate. Sub-28 with a controlled second half and disciplined aid says the sub-100 machinery works. Sub-30 with a four-hour death march says you'll finish Bigfoot in 104 hours, which is a fine day out and not what you asked for.

The gate, restated

The original plan said: finish Bighorn well and Bigfoot is on; DNF or a badly damaged finish and defer. That still holds, with one addition now that the goal has a number on it.

Three outcomes at Bighorn, decided in advance:

- **Under 28 hours, controlled, aid under 90 minutes** → sub-100 is live. Run the plan.
- **28–30 hours, or a finish that cost you two weeks** → Bigfoot is on, sub-100 is not. Race it to finish inside 107, enjoy it, qualify another way.
- **DNF, or an injury finish** → defer Bigfoot. There is another one next year and there is only one of you.

Write that down now, in September, while it's abstract and costs nothing. In June it will cost something.

What still needs your Garmin

Everything above is trackable from Strava. These are not, and the tracker leaves them blank rather than guessing: descent HR gap, aerobic decoupling, HRV, resting HR, sleep and Body Battery, and the three the original plan already flagged as missing — **hill score, endurance score, running tolerance**. Running tolerance matters more now than it did: the vert ramp in Block 1 is the steepest relative jump in the whole plan, and that number is the guardrail on it.